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Al-Muneer Hall Reservations by Ahmed Ghaleb- PSM 1-18-24

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CHAPTER 2

LITERATURE REVIEW

2.1 Introduction

In this chapter, an overview of the latest literature and technology used in relation to the development of the Al-Muneer Online Portal is provided. This chapter explores the area of online venue management systems, emphasizing the change from the traditional way of managing events to modern systems offering greater capabilities. The review covers the key characteristics that are expected to be found in the modern venue portals, including the inquiry management systems, easy process of booking confirmation (providing the evidence of the payment made), feedback collecting system, simple reporting dashboard and notification system. In addition to that, this chapter provides a case study of Al-Muneer Hall in order to place the development of the system into context. The chapter analyzes the drawbacks of the existing process and compares the proposed system to the currently available solutions or alternative processes. In addition to that, this chapter covers the literature on the technology selected for the portal's development.

2.2 Project Domain

The Al-Muneer Online Portal is classified as a specific online portal that offers information, handling queries, and operation services in relation to the sectors of event management and hospitality. The purpose of such systems is to bridge the gap of communication between the venues providers and the potential customers in an efficient manner compared to traditional systems (Sigala et al., 2012; Buhalis & Law, 2008).

2.2.1 Key Features and Information Architecture for Event Venue Portals

The modern-day event venue websites are no longer merely static brochures, but have rather taken up an interactive form. The literature discusses several key features that make a website successful, such as good quality images, transparency of prices, and calls-to-actions for lead generation (Nielsen, 2000). Availability calendars that would provide instant information should be one of the key aspects. In those environments where it is rare to find online payment facilities, it would be useful to provide an opportunity for a user to prove payment made offline (Kshetri, 2013).

2.2.2 Manual Operation Analysis

Current manual system at Al Muneer Hall is common among SMEs but suffers from the followings:

- Time Consumption: Staff spend time on repetitive queries and manual tracking of bookings, payments, and feedback (Laudon & Laudon, 2016).
- Limited Availability: Information and process progression are tied to staff hours.
- Inconsistency: Information can vary; tracking booking confirmations and feedback lacks standardization.
- Challenges in Scalability: Issues with managing growing volume.
- Poor User Experience: Customers want to have simple online experiences such as clear steps to confirm and ways to give feedback (Sigala et al., 2012)
- Documentation and Oversight Challenges: Manual tracking makes it hard to generate operational insights or reliably follow up on client interactions.

2.2.3 Current System Analysis - Comparison of Existing Systems/Approaches

To make a comparative analysis, it is important to describe the categories of the current systems or methodologies that are available for a venue like Al-Muneer Hall to implement. The current manual method of interaction of Al-Muneer Hall involves a lot of direct communication between the staff of the organization and the customers. The communication part is done largely through phone calls, personal meetings and other messaging tools like WhatsApp. This approach allows for a lot of customization but it is very labor intensive and has some limitations on scaling, consistency of information distribution and maintaining the records (Harrigan et al., 2012). Booking, payments, and feedback collection are informal and systemless.

The other type is general online booking sites such as Eventbrite or Cvent. Many opportunities exist with such third-party platforms for hosting event listing, ticketing and sometimes even full event management. They offer users a handy interface to search and book events and services offered. These platforms have a lot of options but they may have their own branding, fees and workflow that do not necessarily align with the interests of an independent venue (Gazzaroli et al., 2019). They are more on ticketed events and not customized venue rental requests.

There are also user-friendly website builders like Wix, Squarespace or GoDaddy Website Builder that help to create a website relatively easily by using predefined templates and drag-and-drop technology (Odoom et al., 2017). These sites are good for simple presence and presentation of the company on the web. However, the built-in abilities to perform dynamic actions like creating a custom calendar of availability, generating customized prices for complex services, collecting payment proof, or any kind of reporting are often limited unless enhanced by third-party plug-ins, which further adds complexities and costs.

And finally there are also quite popular standard static websites of competitors in local businesses. Basically, these websites are online brochures that provide visitors some basic contact information, a gallery and sometimes a list of services. Usually there are no interactive elements to check availability, get dynamic pricing, send structured queries or do any transaction related work online.

A comparative analysis helps to position the proposed Al-Muneer Online Portal:

Table 2.1: Comparative Analysis of Existing Systems and the Proposed Portal

Feature	Al-Muneer Online Portal (Proposed)	Manual (Phone/WhatsApp)	Generic Booking Platforms	Simple Website Builders	Static Competitor Website
Venue-Specific Info	Tailored	(Manual)	Generic Structure	(Manual Setup)	Basic
Interactive Calendar	Yes	No	Often (Complex Setup)	Limited/ Plugin Dependent	Often No
Dynamic Pricing Display	Yes (Admin Managed)	(Verbal/ Manual)	Sometimes (Complex)	Usually No	Often No
Admin Panel	Custom Built	N/A	Yes (Platform Specific)	(General CMS)	N/A
Payment Proof Upload	Yes (Simple)	(Manual Exchange)	Often Not Direct	No	No
Feedback System	Yes	(Ad-hoc)	Sometimes (Platform)	Usually No	No
Basic Reporting	Yes	No	Limited (Platform)	No	No
Notifications	Manual (prefilled messages)	(Manual)	Email Often Primary	No	No
Cultural Context Adapt	High (Custom Design)	High (Direct Interaction)	Low (Standardized)	Medium (Template Dependent)	Medium

2.2.4 Case Study: Al-Muneer Hall for Weddings and Events

In order to contextualize the project in the real-world environment, the following section provides some information on Al-Muneer Hall, the organization where the system will be developed. Al-Muneer Hall (قاعة المنير للأفراح والمناسبات) is an event hall located in Ibb, Yemen. The main activity of this company is the provision of venues for wedding parties, which will help satisfy the needs of the local community and maintain the cultural traditions of Yemeni people associated with these celebrations. Moreover, this hall can provide venues for other kinds of social events such as funerals and celebration parties. Al-Muneer Hall is a single-location business. As far as its structure is concerned, it should be mentioned that Al-Muneer Hall is a family-owned business. The primary stakeholder of the business is Mr. Ahmed Almunajid who is the owner of the company, is involved in the company activities, and communicates with clients. While there might be more staff members helping in organizing the event, cleaning, and other aspects of event hosting, it should be noted that such functions as administration and reservation and communication with customers are performed by Mr. Almunajid or his manager.

In terms of engaging with the stakeholder for the purpose of gathering requirements, the main technique was engaging directly with the owner, Mr. Ahmed Almunajid. First off, there was a discussion arranged through video conference (Google Meet) on April 4, 2025, in order to get to know the business and find out what kind of issues they have and what they want in the online portal. In addition to that, there was a continuous correspondence via WhatsApp for additional details (evidences are provided in communication logs and NABC proposal document (Appendix B)). Based on the findings obtained from such engagement which can be regarded as an interview with the user, it turns out that a major amount of time of Mr. Almunajid is consumed with answering repetitive phone calls related to availability, prices, hall capacity and details. Moreover, there was a need for a professional web site in order to show the hall. In addition, there were specific demands concerning the functionality: there should be an interactive calendar, the way to show prices clearly, media gallery and FAQ section. At present, the process of booking is done via calls or personal visits and usually payments are made in cash but in some cases there can be local bank transfers with screenshot proof of payment. At the moment, there is no system for managing those proofs or any feedbacks at all. Preferences in communication are mostly WhatsApp and calls rather than emails. One of the key needs was the system which could be easily managed and used both by the owner and the clients. After the discussion of the initial proposal and feedback, Mr. Almunajid was ready to introduce a way to upload payment proofs by the clients, a possibility to leave a comment, basic reporting tools and prefilled notifications, ideally WhatsApp.

2.3 Literature Review of Technology Used

The selection of technologies for the Al-Muneer Online Portal is based on their suitability for developing a robust, scalable, and maintainable web application that meets the defined requirements, including the newly added functionalities. For each core technology, alternatives were considered.

Table 2.2: Technology Stack Selection and Justification

Technology	Purpose	Alternatives Considered	Why Chosen / Developer Justification
Spring Boot (Java) / MVC	Backend framework	Python (Django/Flask), Node.js (Express.js), PHP (Laravel)	Spring Boot provides a solid out-of-the-box MVC implementation, which makes it a good choice for a rapid start
MySQL / PostgreSQL	Relational database	NoSQL (MongoDB, Cassandra), SQLite, MS SQL Server	There is no need for NoSQL database for this project because e're not dealing with unstructured type of data. Postgress sounds a good solid choice. Everyone loves it. It does the job perfectly and it's open source.
HTML5, CSS3, JS (Responsive)	Frontend development	JavaScript Frameworks (React, Angular, Vue.js)	"An idiot admires complexity, a genius admires simplicity" — Terry Davis, Creator of Temple OS
Waterfall Model	SDLC methodology	Agile (Scrum, Kanban), Spiral Model	Sounds solid when having clear requirements of a moderate software that does not seem to be needing frequent and high-maintenance in post development
Cloud Hosting (VPS)	Deployment environment	AWS, serverless	VPS is the safest option against DDoS attacks that could cause massive cloud computing bills
Admin Auth (Hashed Pass.)	Secure admin login	Plain text storage (highly insecure), Reversible encryption	The encryption standard in web development
Notification Mechanisms	(e.g., WhatsApp Deep-linking, Email libraries, Manual WhatsApp)	In-app notifications (via web dashboard), Manual WhatsApp message pre-	The chosen notification method—utilizing pre-filled WhatsApp deep links—is simple to implement yet highly effective. This approach meets the stakeholder's primary

	Messaging)	filling.	communication needs without the unnecessary overhead and financial costs associated with complex API integrations, such as the Full WhatsApp Business API, which would offer diminishing returns for a business of this scale.
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Using the great MVC architecture that is provided through Spring Boot, there is a guarantee of separation of concern, hence ensuring simplicity in the management and scalability of the system (Fowler, 2002). Relational databases such as MySQL and PostgreSQL will provide data integrity, which is important in the efficient management of the bookings and venue information (Garcia-Molina et al., 2008). The application of the responsive design through HTML5, CSS3, and JavaScript is very important for today's web application in order to support different users' devices (W3C, 2018). Although Agile development methods are widely used, the formal nature of the waterfall method may have its benefits especially when the initial requirements are clearly defined as stated in the proposal section (Royce, 1970). Providing security through HTTPS and password hashing is vital in keeping the confidence of the users and secure data (Rescorla, 2001; Schneier, 1996).

2.4 Chapter Summary

The chapter has presented a comprehensive literature review on the Al-Muneer Online Portal. This chapter has identified the scope of the project in terms of online event venue management system and discussed important features that have been mentioned in previous researches, including visual-rich design, availability calendar, price listing, feedback form, easy booking process, basic reports generation capabilities, and notification system. Limitations of the traditional manual process have been analyzed in light of the existing situation at Al-Muneer Hall and the necessity of the transition to the digital world has been emphasized. Also, a case study based on Al-Muneer Hall has been conducted in order to describe stakeholders involved in the project and corresponding business requirements. Various types of existing systems, such as booking systems and website building systems, have been analyzed and compared with the custom portal being developed. Finally, this chapter has reviewed the chosen technology stack and discussed other possible options.